

STUDY SHEET - BLOCK 5: CHAPTER FIVE (The Last of the Spirits)

1. Plot (Trama)

The third and final spirit, the Ghost of Christmas Yet To Come (or Future), arrives. It is tall and silent, wearing long, black clothes and a black hood [cite: 5]. It never speaks; it only points with its long, white hand [cite: 5]. Scrooge is very frightened of this mysterious phantom [cite: 5].

The Ghost shows Scrooge various scenes in the future:

1. People in the city are talking about an old, rich, and cruel man who has just died. Nobody cares about him, and some people are even happy about his death.
2. Scrooge sees some thieves who have stolen the dead man's bed curtains and clothes to sell them for money.
3. Scrooge asks to see some tenderness connected with death. The Ghost takes him to the Cratchit house. The family is incredibly sad because **Tiny Tim has died**, but they promise to never forget him [cite: 5].
4. Scrooge then asks to know the identity of the unloved dead man. The Ghost takes him to his own office, but another man is sitting at the desk [cite: 5]. Finally, the Spirit leads him to a dark cemetery and points to a grave [cite: 5]. Trembling, Scrooge goes near it and reads the name on the gravestone: **HERE LIES EBENEZER SCROOGE** [cite: 5].

Scrooge realizes that he is the hated dead man. Desperate, he asks the Ghost if these are things that *must* happen, or only things that are *possible* if he doesn't change [cite: 5]. He falls to his knees, begs for a second chance, and promises to honour Christmas in his heart all year round. As he prays, the phantom's dark clothes collapse into a bedpost.

2. Characters (Personaggi)

- **The Ghost of Christmas Yet To Come (The Last of the Spirits):** A dark, silent figure resembling the Grim Reaper (la Morte). It represents the unknown and inevitable future. Its silence forces Scrooge to realize the truth by himself.
- **Ebenezer Scrooge:** He is now completely terrified but ready to learn. By the end of the chapter, he is completely broken and desperate for redemption. He has fully transformed from a cruel man to a repentant one.
- **The Cratchit Family:** They are mourning (in lutto) the loss of Tiny Tim. Despite their tragic loss, Bob Cratchit finds comfort in his family's love [cite: 5].

3. Themes (Tematiche)

- **Death and Legacy (Morte e Eredità):** The chapter contrasts two deaths. Tiny Tim dies poor but is loved and remembered [cite: 5]. Scrooge dies rich but is completely alone, hated, and robbed. It shows that money cannot buy a good legacy.
- **Free Will and Redemption (Libero arbitrio e Redenzione):** Scrooge asks if the future can be changed [cite: 5]. This is the climax of the story: Dickens wants to show that it is never too late to change our fate through good actions.

4. Useful Vocabulary (Vocabolario utile)

- **Phantom:** Fantasma / Spettro [cite: 5]
- **Hood:** Cappuccio (il fantasma indossa un mantello nero con cappuccio [cite: 5])
- **To point:** Indicare (il fantasma indica solo con la mano [cite: 5])
- **Grave / Cemetery:** Tomba / Cimitero [cite: 5]
- **To tremble:** Tremare (Scrooge trema di paura [cite: 5])
- **To mourn:** Essere in lutto, piangere una morte
- **Future / Yet to Come:** Futuro / Che deve ancora venire [cite: 5]

5. Possible Questions & Short Answers (Domande per la verifica)

- **Q1: What does the Last of the Spirits look like?**
Answer: It is tall and silent. It wears long, black clothes and a black hood, and it only points with a long, white hand [cite: 5].
- **Q2: What sad event has happened to the Cratchit family in the future?**
Answer: Tiny Tim has died, and the family is deeply saddened, though they promise to never forget him [cite: 5].
- **Q3: What name does Scrooge read on the gravestone in the cemetery?**
Answer: He reads his own name: Ebenezer Scrooge [cite: 5]. He realizes he was the unloved dead man.
- **Q4: What is the most important question Scrooge asks the Spirit at the grave?**
Answer: He asks if these things are definitely going to happen, or if they are only "possible" and can be changed if he becomes a better man [cite: 5].